

Figure 3: PuTTY connection screen

installation is straightforward: `sudo apt-get install vsftpd`. After installation, tweak the configuration file to point the default path to `/var/www` (the Apache ‘Webroot’ for hosted content/sites). Edit `/etc/vsftpd.conf` as the root user, with a text editor (here, `nano`), like this: `sudo nano /etc/vsftpd.conf`. Make sure the settings match those shown below:

```
write_enable=YES
local_enable=YES
local_root=/var/www
file_open_mode=0777
```

Restart the FTP service to bring the configuration changes into effect: `sudo restart vsftpd`.

Installing phpMyAdmin

phpMyAdmin is a great tool for administering MySQL databases. Install it using the following command: `sudo apt-get install phpmyadmin`.

We can now exit the PuTTY session, using the exit command.

Deploying a LAMP website

For the purpose of this article, let us deploy a standard version of *phpBB*—the most famous AMP-powered bulletin board system and forum content management system (CMS). I will not go into the installation details, since the aim here is to learn how to generally deploy a LAMP website remotely. Download the archive from the phpBB home page and extract its contents.

Now, using an FTP client, connect to the server with the username and the password used in the PuTTY session. Create a folder called *phpBB* on the server, and copy the extracted files and folders to the root of that directory. Open



Figure 4: Server host key alert

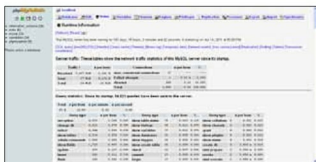


Figure 5: phpMyAdmin status page

a browser and navigate to `http://210.22.23.24/phpmyadmin` (replace the IP address with yours) to bring up the phpMyAdmin page (Figure 5). Create a new database named *phpbb*—go to the *Database* tab and use the *Create New Database* section at the bottom. You can now proceed to a site-specific installation by navigating to `http://210.22.23.24/phpbb`. Follow the instructions on the page.

We have now successfully set up our server, and learnt how to remotely control it! I hope you had fun learning, during this process. Until next time, cheers! 

Links

- Ubuntu Server: <http://www.ubuntu.com/business/server/overview>
- PuTTY: <http://www.chiark.greenend.org.uk/~sgtatham/putty/download.html>
- vsftpd: <https://security.appspot.com/vsftpd.html>
- phpMyAdmin: http://www.phpmyadmin.net/home_page/index.php
- phpBB: <http://www.phpbb.com/>

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